Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	1 — Geographical Diversity of India
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: **+4** for each correct answer · **−1** for each wrong answer · **0** if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. This is the hardest paper in the ladder: reason in multi-step chains, read described data and scenarios, and synthesise across regions. Hold firm on the classic traps — a desert means low rainfall not heat (so cold dry Ladakh counts), the towering Himalayas are young and still rising while the worn-low Aravallis are ancient, the tall unbroken Western Ghats sit on the WEST coast while the low river-cut Eastern Ghats sit on the EAST, coral low-lying Lakshadweep (Arabian Sea) must never be swapped with volcanic forested Andaman & Nicobar (Bay of Bengal), and a sediment-built fertile delta is neither a funnel-shaped estuary nor a bar-enclosed lagoon. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. A class is told that of India's five physiographic regions, exactly one owes its very existence to the building of another. Which pairing names the dependent region and the region that created it?

(A) the Himalayas, raised by silt washed off the Northern Plains
(B) the Peninsular Plateau, built from lava flowing out of the Himalayas
(C) the Northern Plains, built from sediment eroded off the Himalayas
(D) the islands, formed from sand blown off the Thar Desert

2. A geographer ranks India's five regions by the GEOLOGICAL AGE of their dominant rock or material, oldest first. Which ordering is correct?

(A) Peninsular Plateau, then Aravalli-type old folds, then the young Himalayas, then the still-younger Northern Plains alluvium

(B) the Northern Plains, then the Himalayas, then the Peninsular Plateau, then the Aravallis

(C) the Himalayas, then the Northern Plains, then the Peninsular Plateau, then the Aravallis

(D) all five regions are of exactly the same age because they belong to one country

3. Two peaks are watched for a century. Peak X (a Himadri giant) gains a little height; Peak Y (a worn Aravalli summit) loses a little. A student says 'so the rock of X must be harder than the rock of Y.' The flaw in that reasoning is that:

(A) height change here is driven by active uplift on X versus erosion on Y that no longer rises, not by which rock is harder

(B) X is actually eroding faster than Y, so the comparison is reversed

(C) rock hardness is the only thing that ever changes a mountain's height

(D) both peaks are in fact staying exactly the same height

4. Standing in the same Himalayan valley, a traveller sees year-round snowfields above, cool pine-clad hill towns at mid-level, and warm gravelly foothills below. The SINGLE underlying variable that best explains all three belts at once is:

(A) altitude, since air grows colder and thinner the higher you go

(B) the age at which each belt was formed(C) the colour of the rock in each belt

(D) the distance of each belt from the nearest ocean

5. The Himalayas are praised both for blocking icy northern winds AND for storing water that feeds summer rivers. A student asks which property does each job. The correct matching is:

(A) their stored snow blocks the cold winds, while their height feeds the rivers

(B) their great HEIGHT walls off the cold winds, while their stored SNOW and ICE feed the rivers

(C) their rock colour blocks the winds, while their age feeds the rivers

(D) both jobs are done only by the rivers flowing down them

6. If a deep canyon were cut clean through the Himalayan wall opening a low gap to Central Asia, the chapter's logic predicts north India would MOST likely become:

(A) hotter and far wetter, as tropical sea winds rush through the gap

(B) completely unchanged, since one gap cannot affect a whole region's climate

(C) a permanent snowfield, as the gap fills with Himalayan ice

(D) colder in winter and drier, as cold winds pour through and the monsoon is no longer fully trapped

7. A drill log on the Northern Plains reads: 'kilometres of soft layered silt, then hard rock.' A drill log on the Deccan reads: 'hard rock almost at once.' Read together, the two logs prove that:

(A) the plains sit in a sinking trough long filled by river silt, while the Deccan is an old solid rock block

(B) the plains are an ancient rock block and the Deccan is freshly deposited silt

(C) both regions are made of the same depth of river silt

(D) the plains rest on cooled volcanic lava and the Deccan on deep alluvium

8. A farmer wants land that is re-fertilised by nature every single year without any effort. Within the chapter, the BEST place is:

(A) the higher older bhangar terrace away from the floods

(B) the hard rocky surface of the Deccan Plateau

(C) the low khadar strip beside a river that floods yearly with fresh silt

(D) a high cold valley floor in Ladakh

9. Two soils are sampled near a river: Soil 1 is light, freshly laid and lime-free; Soil 2 is higher, older and dotted with lime nodules. The correct labels AND the more fertile sample are:

(A) Soil 1 is bhangar and is more fertile; Soil 2 is khadar and is less fertile

(B) Soil 1 is khadar and is more fertile; Soil 2 is bhangar and is less fertile

(C) Soil 1 is khadar and is less fertile; Soil 2 is bhangar and is more fertile

(D) both are bhangar and equally fertile

10. City planners note that India's densest belt of great cities follows the Northern Plains rather than the Shivalik foothills just above. Combining soil, water and slope, the deepest reason is:

(A) the foothills are simply too hot for any human to live in

(B) flat, well-watered, deep-alluvium plains make farming, building and travel all easy at once

(C) the plains are the only land in India that ever receives rain

(D) the foothills have no rivers crossing them at all

11. Arrange the FULL chain that turns a slow plate collision into a bowl of rice grown on the plains, in correct cause-then-effect order:

(A) crops grow first, then silt settles, then rivers erode the peaks, then the Himalayas rise

(B) silt settles on the plains, then the collision lifts the mountains, then rivers form to erode them

(C) plate collision lifts the Himalayas, rivers erode the peaks, rivers carry the silt down, silt settles as fertile alluvium, crops grow on it

(D) the Himalayas erode away completely, then a sea floods the plains, then rice is grown on the seabed

12. A textbook calls the Himalayas a single mountain ZONE yet also names three RANGES within it. The best way to reconcile these two statements is that:

(A) the three ranges lie in three different countries far apart

(B) the zone is one continuous belt subdivided by height into the Himadri, Himachal and Shivalik ranges

(C) only one of the three ranges is truly part of the Himalayas

(D) the words zone and range mean exactly the same thing here

13. A trekker descending the Himalayas records the air getting warmer and the trees changing from snow scrub to pine forest to subtropical jungle. The order of ranges this descent passes through is:

(A) Shivalik, then Himachal, then Himadri(B) Himachal, then Shivalik, then Himadri

(C) Himadri, then Shivalik, then Himachal(D) Himadri, then Himachal, then Shivalik

14. A river engineer must pick the river LEAST likely to dry up in a rainless May, to feed a year-round canal. The best choice, and why, is:

(A) a Himalayan river, because melting snow and glaciers feed it even when no rain falls

(B) a Deccan rain-fed river, because plateau rivers store the most water

(C) the shortest river available, because short rivers lose the least water

(D) any river, because all Indian rivers carry the same water all year

15. Two rivers begin the dry season equally full. River P is snow-and-glacier-fed; River Q is purely rain-fed. By late spring, the correct prediction is:

(A) Q still flows strongly while P has dried up

(B) P still flows strongly while Q has shrunk to a trickle

(C) both have dried up equally because neither gets rain

(D) both flow equally strongly because all rivers behave alike

16. On a relief map, most Deccan rivers arrow eastward to the Bay of Bengal, but the Narmada and Tapti arrow westward. The single fact that explains BOTH the rule and its exception is:

(A) the Bay of Bengal sits higher and pulls most rivers toward it

(B) the Narmada and Tapti flow uphill into the Western Ghats

(C) all peninsular rivers actually flow north into the Ganga

(D) the plateau generally tilts east so most rivers run that way, while the Narmada and Tapti follow rift valleys west against that tilt

17. A mining company has flattened a Deccan hill and a stretch of the Aravalli ridge. Within the chapter, the two MOST likely consequences, matched correctly, are:

(A) the Deccan loses mineral-bearing rock, and the levelled Aravallis let the Thar's sand creep east toward Delhi

(B) the Deccan gains fresh alluvium, and the Aravallis start the Himalayas rising faster

(C) both actions make the Ganga reverse direction

(D) both actions raise India's southern coastline out of the sea

18. A geologist links two facts: the Western Ghats stand high and unbroken, and the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri all reach the eastern sea. The single structure that explains both at once is:

(A) the Eastern Ghats are higher than the Western Ghats, blocking the rivers westward

(B) the Deccan block is tilted up on its western edge, so its rivers run down the slope to the east

(C) the plateau is perfectly flat, so the river directions are pure chance

(D) the rivers are pulled uphill toward the higher western rim

19. A teacher says the Deccan is rich in MINERALS while the Northern Plains are rich for FARMING, and asks why each wealth sits where it does. The correct linkage is:

(A) young alluvium gave the Deccan its minerals, while ancient rock made the plains fertile

(B) both regions are rich for the very same reason, namely Himalayan silt

(C) ancient hard rock concentrated minerals in the Deccan, while young deep alluvium made the plains fertile

(D) the sea deposited both the minerals and the farmland soil alike

20. Two ranges are compared: one is a tall continuous wall broken only rarely, the other is low and chopped into many gaps by rivers. Naming them with their coasts, the correct statement is:

(A) the high unbroken wall is the Eastern Ghats on the east coast; the low gapped hills are the Western Ghats on the west coast

(B) both are the Western Ghats, one on each coast

(C) the high wall is the Himadri and the low hills are the Shivaliks

(D) the high unbroken wall is the Western Ghats on the west coast; the low gapped hills are the Eastern Ghats on the east coast

21. A botanist seeking communities that have lived for ages in the dense interior forests of the central plateau should look for the:

(A) forest-dwelling tribal peoples such as the Gond and Bhil

(B) the cold-desert herders of the Ladakh valleys

(C) the coral-island fishers of Lakshadweep

(D) the mangrove-delta dwellers of the Sundarbans

22. A delta and an estuary form at different river mouths. Picking the conditions that produce a DELTA rather than an estuary, the correct set is:

(A) a long, slow, sediment-heavy river meeting a calm, sheltered sea

(B) a short, swift, sediment-poor river meeting a rough, open sea

(C) any river meeting any sea, since the mouth shape is random

(D) a river flowing uphill into a high mountain lake

23. The east coast carries broad fertile deltas while the west coast mostly forms creeks, coves and estuaries. The reason that ties river length, slope AND sea conditions together is:

(A) the west coast gets no rain, so its rivers carry no water at all

(B) the east coast has no rivers, only lakes and lagoons

(C) long, gentle east rivers drop heavy sediment into the calm Bay, while short, steep west rivers carry little into the open, rough Arabian Sea

(D) deltas form only where the sea is saltier, and the Bay is saltier

24. Chilika and Pulicat are described as water bodies partly cut off from the sea by bars and spits along the east coast. The correct landform name is:

(A) coral atolls of the Arabian Sea

(B) high glacial lakes of the Himadri

(C) coastal lagoons

(D) volcanic crater lakes of the Deccan

25. Why does the Ganga's mouth build a vast spreading delta while a short Konkan river on the west coast builds almost none?

(A) the Ganga carries no sediment while the west river carries a great deal

(B) the Bay of Bengal is rougher than the Arabian Sea, so it builds more land

(C) the long Ganga drops a huge sediment load into the calm Bay, while the short west river carries little into the rough open sea

(D) the west river is far longer and slower than the Ganga

26. A captain reports two Indian island groups: one low, flat and ringed by coral; one higher, forested and built of volcanic rock. Matching each to its sea, the correct statement is:

(A) the coral group is Andaman & Nicobar in the Bay of Bengal; the volcanic group is Lakshadweep in the Arabian Sea

(B) the coral group is Lakshadweep in the Arabian Sea; the volcanic group is Andaman & Nicobar in the Bay of Bengal

(C) both groups are coral and lie in the Arabian Sea

(D) both groups are volcanic and lie in the Bay of Bengal

27. A naturalist plans two trips: one to study coral reefs growing in warm shallow seas, one to see an active volcano. The correct destinations, in that order, are:

(A) the Andamans for the coral, then Lakshadweep for the volcano

(B) the Sundarbans for the coral, then the Aravallis for the volcano

(C) both targets are found only in the Lakshadweep group

(D) Lakshadweep for the coral, then the Andaman & Nicobar group for Barren Island's volcano

28. Why is one Indian island group low and coral while the other is high and volcanic? The deepest reason is:

(A) one group is simply much older and has worn down into coral

(B) their different origins: coral builds up in warm shallow seas, while volcanoes rise where the Earth's plates interact

(C) one group gets monsoon rain and the other gets none

(D) the two seas differ only in temperature, which sets the rock type

29. The Sundarbans, home of the Royal Bengal Tiger, lies in a single great landform shared by two countries. Both the landform AND the pair are:

(A) the Indus delta, shared by India and Pakistan

(B) the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, shared by India and Myanmar

(C) the Kaveri delta, shared by India and Sri Lanka

(D) the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, shared by India and Bangladesh

30. A child insists 'Ladakh can't be a desert — it's freezing, and deserts are hot.' The single accurate correction is:

(A) Ladakh actually gets very heavy rainfall, so the child is half right

(B) a desert is defined by very low rainfall, so a cold, dry place like Ladakh is a cold desert

(C) a desert must have tall sand dunes, which Ladakh lacks

(D) a desert must lie below sea level, which Ladakh does not

31. A quiz lists four traits: 'high salt lakes, snow leopards, winters below freezing, no rain for months.' These together describe:

(A) the cold desert of Ladakh

(B) the hot Thar Desert

(C) the Sundarbans mangrove delta

(D) the wet Khasi hills of the Northeast

32. Thar villagers scrub pots with sand and store rain in taanka and kund tanks. Reasoning from cause to custom, the correct chain is:

(A) sand is believed to clean better than any amount of water could

(B) water is extremely scarce, so every drop is saved and plentiful sand is used where water would be wasted

(C) the nights are too cold to allow washing with water

(D) local rules forbid using river water for ordinary chores

33. The Aravalli range blocks the Thar's sand from spreading east. The two facts about the range that together make it effective are:

(A) it is extremely tall and snow-capped, chilling the desert winds

(B) it is made of loose sand that soaks up the blowing sand

(C) it forms a long continuous ridge AND it runs along the desert's eastern flank, in the sand's path

(D) it lies far south of the desert and catches the sand only by chance

34. Mount Abu, about 1,700 m, is the highest point of its range and the range's only real hill station. That range is:

(A) the snow-covered Himadri range

(B) the high western coastal wall, the Western Ghats

(C) the youngest Shivalik foothills of the Himalayas

(D) the ancient, worn-low Aravalli range

35. A student sorts 'Ladakh, the Thar, and the Sundarbans' by landform type. The correct grouping is:

(A) all three are hot deserts of sand and rock(B) all three are river deltas built of silt

(C) Ladakh and the Thar are deltas, and the Sundarbans is a desert

(D) Ladakh a cold desert, the Thar a hot desert, the Sundarbans a mangrove delta

36. India stretches from about 8 degrees N near its southern tip to about 37 degrees N at its northern edge. Reasoning from latitude ALONE, the correct conclusion is:

(A) the northern edge, being at higher latitude, is the warmest part of India

(B) both ends have identical temperatures because both lie north of the Equator

(C) the southern tip, nearer the Equator, tends to be warmer year-round than the northern edge

(D) the southern tip is colder because it is farther from the Himalayan snows

37. The Tropic of Cancer (about 23.5 degrees N) runs across India's middle through Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal. The most useful climatic consequence is that:

(A) the whole of India therefore lies in the cold temperate zone

(B) places exactly on the line never receive overhead sun at any time

(C) land south of the line lies in the tropics and stays hot most of the year, while land to its north is more seasonal and subtropical

(D) the line marks the physical boundary between the plains and the Himalayas

38. Because India spans a wide east-west distance, sunrise reaches the far east noticeably before the far west. This is direct evidence that India has:

(A) a large longitudinal extent, so eastern places turn into sunlight before western ones

(B) a large latitudinal extent, which is why the east is hotter

(C) such a small size that the sun rises everywhere at once

(D) faster rotation in its eastern parts than in its western parts

39. A student combines two facts: India's far south is hotter than its far north, AND its east sees sunrise before its west. Together these two facts are best explained by:

(A) India's small size in both directions

(B) the Himalayas still slowly rising in the north

(C) India's large extent in BOTH latitude and longitude

(D) the whole country lying in one narrow band of latitude and longitude

40. Why is the windward sea-facing slope of the Western Ghats drenched while the land just behind the crest is much drier?

(A) the moist winds rise and drop most of their rain on the windward slope, leaving little for the sheltered rain-shadow side

(B) the sheltered side is a separate unrelated desert with its own climate

(C) the sea-facing slope blocks all sunlight, freezing the back into a frost zone

(D) rivers on the back side carry the rain away before it can fall there

41. The west coast is soaked by the monsoon and the Khasi hills are among the wettest places on Earth, for the SAME basic reason. That shared mechanism is:

(A) both regions lie beside large hot deserts that push moisture onto them

(B) both regions are built of coral rock that attracts rain clouds

(C) moist monsoon winds forced to rise over high ground, cool, and shed heavy rain (orographic rainfall)

(D) both regions lie below sea level where rainwater naturally collects

42. A traveller notes that high mountain slopes are farmed only in small terraces with much herding, while the plains are farmed in vast fields. The single underlying cause of this difference in farming is:

(A) relief: steep cold slopes limit farming to terraces and herding, while flat warm plains allow wide intensive cropping

(B) the mountains farm more intensively because their cooler air suits crops better

(C) both regions farm identically because they share the same rivers

(D) neither region can support any farming of any kind

43. Large cities and dense villages crowd the Northern Plains but are sparse in the Thar Desert. Combining soil and water, the reason is:

(A) the desert is far too cold for people to survive in

(B) the plains are the only flat land in the whole of India

(C) the desert receives no sunlight for most of the year

(D) the plains offer fertile soil and reliable river water, while the desert's scarce water and poor soil limit how many people the land can feed

44. A wildlife survey finds snow leopards in the cold high north, the Royal Bengal Tiger in eastern mangroves, and coral fish around western islands. The single best conclusion is:

(A) India's many different physical regions create many habitats, each suited to different wildlife

(B) all Indian animals can live in any region equally well

(C) wildlife in India does not depend on geography at all

(D) every region of India is home to the same set of animals

45. India's biodiversity ranges from snow leopards to mangrove tigers to coral fish. The deepest reason this single country holds such variety is that:

(A) one uniform warm climate across the country suits all these animals

(B) its many physical regions and climates create many different habitats

(C) all these animals were brought in from other continents

(D) the country has only one habitat type that every species shares

46. History shows traders and armies still reached India despite the Himalayas, the Thar and the surrounding seas. The best conclusion about these natural barriers is that they:

(A) never really acted as barriers at all

(B) made movement harder but did not seal the country off completely

(C) blocked the flow of rivers but never the movement of people

(D) were built by people rather than formed by nature

47. Which single combination of features best explains why India developed a distinctive climate and culture, somewhat sheltered from the wider world?

(A) a scatter of random low hills with no overall pattern

(B) the river deltas of the east coast acting on their own

(C) the coral reefs of Lakshadweep acting on their own

(D) the Himalayas, the Thar with the Arabian Sea, and the surrounding oceans acting together to limit easy movement in and out

48. Great rivers like the Ganga are said to UNITE India's very different regions. The sense in which this is true is that they:

(A) link mountains, plains and coasts, carrying people, goods and ideas between distant places

(B) give every region exactly the same weather and climate

(C) physically connect the Himalayas directly to the distant islands

(D) flatten the whole country into one single uniform plain

49. The chapter's central idea is that India's sharply contrasting regions still form one nation. This is best captured by the phrase:

(A) survival of the fittest (B) divide and rule

(C) out of sight, out of mind (D) unity in diversity

50. Why do geographers divide a vast country like India into physical regions instead of treating it as one uniform space?

(A) because every part of India looks exactly alike

(B) because ancient kings once drew those boundaries

(C) because each region happens to speak one single language

(D) grouping land by height, slope, rock and water lets us compare regions and explain why life differs from place to place

51. A student summarises: 'India is one country, but its mountains, plains, desert, plateau, coasts and islands each shape their own way of life.' The single statement that BEST completes this big picture is:

(A) so geography has no real effect on where or how people live

(B) so only the Himalayas matter and the other regions do not

(C) each region shapes its own climate, wildlife and life, yet rivers and shared history still bind them into one nation

(D) so all of India must live the same way because the land is the same

52. A student claims 'the Himalayas must be very old because they are so tall.' The correct correction, rooted in the chapter, is that:

(A) yes, the tallest mountains are always the oldest

(B) they are tall because their rock is the hardest in India

(C) they are tall because they are young, still-rising fold mountains, while truly old ranges like the Aravallis are worn low

(D) they are tall only because snow piles up and adds height

53. If the Indian plate stopped pushing north against Asia, the chapter's logic predicts the Himalayas would over very long time:

(A) collapse all at once into the Northern Plains

(B) keep rising on their own because tall mountains lift themselves

(C) stop gaining height and be slowly worn lower by erosion, like an old range

(D) turn into a desert as their rivers immediately stop flowing

54. Marine fossils are found in high Himalayan rock though no sea lies there today. Used as evidence, this best supports the claim that:

(A) glaciers froze sea creatures into the peaks where they remain

(B) land now at great height was once a sea floor, folded upward when two landmasses collided

(C) the present Arabian Sea once rose over the peaks and drained away

(D) rivers carried the shells uphill from the plains to the summits

55. The three Himalayan ranges form three distinct climate belts. The chapter's reason is that:

(A) each range was raised in a different era that froze in its climate

(B) each range sits at a different altitude, and air grows colder and thinner with height

(C) each range is built of a different rock that gives off a different amount of heat

(D) only the lowest range gets sunlight, leaving the higher two dark and cold

56. A captain sailing AROUND peninsular India from the Arabian Sea to the Bay of Bengal would pass the two island groups in which order?

(A) volcanic Andaman & Nicobar first in the Arabian Sea, then coral Lakshadweep in the Bay of Bengal

(B) coral Lakshadweep first in the Arabian Sea, then volcanic Andaman & Nicobar in the Bay of Bengal

(C) coral Lakshadweep first in the Bay of Bengal, then volcanic Andaman & Nicobar in the Arabian Sea

(D) both groups in the Arabian Sea, since all of India's islands lie to the west

57. Why does the Northern Plains form one long continuous lowland rather than a chain of separate basins?

(A) a single volcano flooded the whole region with one even sheet of lava

(B) the sea once covered it and left one flat layer of salt

(C) glaciers ground the entire region flat in one continuous sweep

(D) many Himalayan rivers have spread and merged their alluvium across one long trough in front of the mountains

58. A short, swift river carrying little sediment empties into a rough, open sea. Compared with a long slow river entering a calm sea, it most likely forms:

(A) a larger delta, because swift rivers always carry the most sediment

(B) a coral reef, because fast rivers warm the water at their mouths

(C) a wide lagoon, because swift rivers always cut off a bar of new land

(D) an estuary with little new land, because the rough sea sweeps its small load away

59. Three coastal water features are described: a fan of new land split by channels, a water body cut off by a sand bar, and a funnel where fresh and salt water mix. In that order, they are:

(A) a delta, a lagoon, and an estuary

(B) an estuary, a delta, and a lagoon

(C) a lagoon, an estuary, and a delta

(D) three different deltas of different sizes

60. A geologist drills deep into the Northern Plains and finds the buried bedrock dips lower and lower toward the foot of the Himalayas. The best explanation within the chapter is that:

(A) the bedrock was pushed up highest right at the mountain front

(B) a sheet of cooled lava grows thicker away from the mountains

(C) the sea floor rose most steeply nearest the Himalayas

(D) the plains lie in a trough that has been sinking and filling with river-borne mountain sediment over long ages

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 1: Geographical Diversity of India — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: **+4** correct, **−1** wrong, **0** unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	A	31	A	41	C	51	C
2	A	12	B	22	A	32	B	42	A	52	C
3	A	13	D	23	C	33	C	43	D	53	C
4	A	14	A	24	C	34	D	44	A	54	B
5	B	15	B	25	C	35	D	45	B	55	B
6	D	16	D	26	B	36	C	46	B	56	B
7	A	17	A	27	D	37	C	47	D	57	D
8	C	18	B	28	B	38	A	48	A	58	D
9	B	19	C	29	D	39	C	49	D	59	A
10	B	20	D	30	B	40	A	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The plains are a deposit of alluvium that Himalayan rivers carried down from the rising mountains, so the plains depend on the Himalayas for their material. Silt from the flat low plains cannot raise high mountains; uplift comes from the plate collision, not from deposited sediment. The plateau is built of ancient hard rock and old lava from its own region, unrelated to any Himalayan lava. The coral and volcanic islands form in the seas, not from desert sand carried hundreds of kilometres out to sea.

2. (A) The peninsular block and the Aravallis are among the most ancient parts of India, the Himalayas are young fold mountains, and the plains' alluvium is the very youngest material since it is still being laid down today. Putting the freshly deposited plains first reverses the order, as new silt is the youngest, not the oldest. Listing the young Himalayas before the ancient plateau again inverts the ages. Belonging to one country says nothing about rock age, which spans from ancient crust to present-day silt.

3. (A) X grows because the plate collision still squeezes the young Himalayas upward while Y, an ancient range that stopped rising, is simply being worn down; the difference is uplift versus none, not hardness. X is rising, not eroding faster than Y, so the reversal is false. Hardness affects only the speed of erosion, not whether a range is being actively uplifted, so it cannot be the sole control. The observation explicitly states X gains and Y loses height, so 'staying the same' contradicts the data.

4. (A) All three belts lie in one valley but at different heights, and because air cools and thins with altitude, the highest stays snowbound, the middle mild and the lowest warm. Formation age does not set today's temperature; present altitude does. Rock colour does not control how warm a belt is. Distance to the ocean is nearly the same for belts stacked in one valley, so it cannot explain the sharp temperature steps between them.

5. (B) A towering wall is what stops cold Central-Asian winds from crossing, and the frozen reservoir of snow and ice is what melts to keep summer rivers flowing, so each job has a distinct cause. Stored snow does not form the barrier; the sheer height does. Rock colour and age have nothing to do with either function. The rivers are the result of melting ice, not the cause of the wind-blocking, so they cannot do both jobs alone.

6. (D) The wall both blocks cold northern winds and traps the rain-bearing monsoon, so a gap would let cold air in and let moisture escape, making winters colder and the region drier. Tropical sea winds come from the south, not through a northern gap, so 'hotter and wetter' is backwards. A breach in the main barrier would have a large effect, so 'unchanged' is wrong. Losing the barrier brings drier, colder air, not a buildup of snow.

7. (A) Deep soft silt over a buried floor shows the plains are a river-filled subsiding trough, while rock at the surface shows the Deccan is a solid old block. The logs say the opposite of 'plains ancient rock, Deccan silt,' so that swap is wrong. The two logs differ sharply, so they cannot show equal silt depth. Lava underlies parts of the Deccan, not the plains, so that pairing reverses the two regions.

8. (C) The khadar floodplain receives a new layer of nutrient-rich silt every flood, so nature renews it yearly on its own. The bhangar terrace lies above the floods and is not refreshed, making it the less fertile, older soil. The Deccan's thin soil over hard rock is not annually renewed by floods. A cold Ladakh valley is a high dry desert, not a yearly-flooded fertile floodplain.

9. (B) Fresh, light, lime-free silt on the low floodplain is khadar, the newer and more fertile alluvium, while the older, higher, lime-flecked terrace is bhangar, the less fertile one. Calling the fresh light soil bhangar swaps the names. Khadar is the more fertile, not the less fertile, of the two. The samples differ in age and fertility, so 'both bhangar and equal' is false.

10. (B) The plains combine flat land, reliable river water and deep fertile soil, so farming, construction and movement are all easy, which is why cities cluster there. The foothills are not uninhabitably hot; their problem is rugged terrain, not heat. Rainfall is not unique to the plains, so that claim fails. Rivers do descend through the Shivaliks, so 'no rivers' is false; relief and soil drive the choice.

11. (C) Uplift must come first, then erosion of the peaks, then transport of silt, then its deposition as fertile soil, and only then can crops grow on it; each step causes the next. Crops cannot grow before the soil that feeds them exists, so that order is upside down. Silt cannot settle before the mountains and rivers that produce it form. The mountains have not vanished nor has a sea flooded the plains, so that scenario is fiction.

12. (B) The Himalayan zone is one belt that rises in three steps, the high Himadri, the middle Himachal and the low Shivalik, so it is both one zone and three ranges. The three ranges run side by side within India, not in separate distant countries. All three belong to the Himalayas; none is excluded. A zone is the whole belt while a range is one step within it, so the two words are not identical.

13. (D) Going down means leaving the snowy Himadri first, crossing the pine-forested Himachal, then reaching the warm low Shivalik foothills last. Shivalik-first is the climbing order, the reverse of a descent. Placing Shivalik before the higher Himachal misorders the foothills above the mid-belt. Putting Shivalik before Himachal in the last pair again misplaces the lowest range above the middle one.

14. (A) Snow- and glacier-fed Himalayan rivers receive meltwater through the warm rainless months, so they keep flowing when rain stops. A rain-fed Deccan river shrinks to a trickle without rain, the opposite of reliable. River length does not determine year-round flow; the source of water does. Rivers clearly differ by season, so 'all the same all year' is false.

15. (B) Meltwater keeps the snow-fed P flowing through the warm dry months, while the rain-fed Q, with no rain, dwindles. Reversing this makes the rain-fed river the reliable one, which is wrong. P has a meltwater source, so it does not dry up like Q, ruling out 'both dried up.' The two rivers have different sources, so they do not behave alike.

16. (D) The eastward tilt sends most rivers to the Bay, while the Narmada and Tapti are the rare westward exceptions running to the Arabian Sea. Water cannot be pulled uphill toward a higher sea; rivers run down the tilt to the low east. Rivers do not flow uphill into the Ghats. Peninsular rivers reach the seas east and west, not north into the Ganga, so that claim is false.

17. (A) The Deccan's ancient rock holds minerals, so removing it loses ore, while the Aravalli ridge blocks wind-blown sand, so flattening it lets the Thar spread east. Mining removes rock rather than adding alluvium, and the Aravallis have nothing to do with

Himalayan uplift. The Ganga follows the plains' slope and would not reverse. The southern coastline is set by the sea, not by inland mining.

18. (B) A westward tilt raises the western rim into the high Western Ghats and slopes the land down to the east, guiding the rivers eastward, so one tilt explains both. The Western Ghats are the higher rim, not the Eastern, so that reversal is wrong. A flat block would not give every major river one consistent eastward direction. Rivers run downhill away from the high western rim, not uphill toward it.

19. (C) Vast time let minerals accumulate in the Deccan's ancient hard rock, while Himalayan rivers laid deep fertile alluvium on the plains, so each wealth matches its own material. Swapping these makes young silt the source of minerals and old rock the source of fertility, which reverses the geology. Only the plains have the deep alluvium, so 'same reason' fails. The interior wealth comes from each region's own rock and silt, not from the sea.

20. (D) The west-coast Western Ghats form the tall near-continuous wall, while the east-coast Eastern Ghats are lower and cut into gaps by rivers. Swapping their names and coasts is the classic Ghats trap. The two Ghats lie on opposite coasts, so they cannot both be 'Western.' The Himadri and Shivaliks are northern Himalayan ranges, not the coastal Ghats of the peninsula.

21. (A) The Gond and Bhil are forest-dwelling tribal communities long settled in the central plateau's forests. Ladakh's herders live in the far northern cold desert, a different region. Lakshadweep's fishers live on Arabian-Sea coral islands. The Sundarbans dwellers live in the eastern mangrove delta; none of these inhabits the plateau forests.

22. (A) Heavy sediment delivered slowly into a calm sea settles and builds the new land of a delta. A short swift river meeting a rough sea has its small load swept away, forming an estuary instead, the opposite condition. Mouth shape is not random; it depends on sediment and sea conditions. Rivers do not flow uphill into mountain lakes, so that option is impossible.

23. (C) Long, slow eastward rivers deliver large sediment loads into the calm Bay and build deltas, while short steep west rivers reach the rough open Arabian Sea with little sediment. The west coast does get heavy monsoon rain, so 'no water' is false. The east coast plainly has major rivers, not only lakes. Sediment supply and a calm sea, not saltiness, control delta formation.

24. (C) A shallow body of water partly enclosed from the sea by a bar or spit is a lagoon, and Chilika and Pulicat are exactly that on the east coast. Coral atolls ring warm Arabian-Sea islands, not the east coast. Glacial lakes lie high in the Himalayas, far from the coast. Crater lakes form in volcanoes on the plateau, not behind coastal bars; the east-coast setting marks them as lagoons.

25. (C) The long Ganga gathers a heavy sediment load and lays it down in the calm Bay, building a delta, while the short swift west river delivers little to a rough sea. The Ganga carries abundant sediment, not none, so that is reversed. The calm Bay, not a rough one, favours delta growth. The Konkan rivers are short and swift, not longer and slower than the Ganga.

26. (B) Low coral Lakshadweep lies in the Arabian Sea to the west, and higher volcanic Andaman & Nicobar lies in the Bay of Bengal to the east. Swapping their formations and seas is the classic island trap. The two groups differ in formation, so 'both coral' is wrong. They also lie in different seas, so 'both volcanic in the Bay' is false.

27. (D) Coral reefs build the warm shallow Lakshadweep, while India's only active volcano, Barren Island, sits in the volcanic Andaman & Nicobar group. Reversing them puts coral in the volcanic group and the volcano among the coral islands, which is wrong. Coral does not grow in muddy Sundarbans mangroves, and the Aravallis are inland hills with no volcano. The two features sit in two different groups, not one.

28. (B) How an island forms decides its nature, with coral accumulating in warm shallow water and volcanic rock rising at a plate setting. Age does not turn volcanic rock into coral. Both groups receive rain, so rainfall is not the cause. A small temperature difference does not by itself set rock type; the formation process does.

29. (D) The Sundarbans mangroves and the tiger occupy the Ganga–Brahmaputra delta, which India shares with Bangladesh. The Indus delta lies in the northwest along Pakistan, not the tiger's mangrove home. Myanmar lies to the east and does not share this delta. The Kaveri delta is in the far south and is not the shared mangrove delta described.

30. (B) Rainfall, not heat, defines a desert, so the dry high-altitude Ladakh is a cold desert. Ladakh is dry, not heavily rained on, so 'half right' is false. Sand dunes are typical of hot deserts but are not required for a region to be a desert. Elevation relative to the sea is irrelevant; low rainfall is the only test.

31. (A) High salt lakes, the snow leopard, bitter winters and scant rain are the hallmarks of cold, dry Ladakh. The Thar is a hot desert with golden dunes and scorching days, not freezing winters and snow leopards. The Sundarbans is a wet mangrove delta, the opposite of a dry desert. The Khasi hills are among the wettest places on Earth, not a rainless desert.

32. (B) Scarcity drives the custom: with so little water, people save every drop and use abundant sand for cleaning. It is not a belief that sand outcleans water; it is conservation. Cold nights are not the reason in the hot Thar. No rule bans river water; the point is that very little water is available.

33. (C) A long unbroken ridge standing on the desert's eastern edge sits directly in the path of wind-blown sand and blocks it. The Aravallis are low and worn, not tall and snow-capped, so chilling winds is not the mechanism. They are folded rock, not loose absorbing sand. They lie along the eastern flank, not far south by chance; position and ridge form are what matter.

34. (D) Mount Abu crowns the old, worn Aravalli range, whose modest height fits an ancient eroded range. The Himadri carries peaks far higher than 1,700 m, so Mount Abu is not its summit. The Western Ghats are a separate southern coastal wall. The Shivaliks are northern Himalayan foothills, not the range Mount Abu belongs to.

35. (D) Ladakh is a high cold desert, the Thar a hot sandy desert, and the Sundarbans a wet mangrove forest in a delta, so each is a distinct type. They are not all hot deserts, since Ladakh is cold and the Sundarbans wet. They are not all deltas, since the two deserts are dry. Labelling the deserts as deltas and the delta as a desert reverses the facts.

36. (C) Lower-latitude land nearer the Equator receives more direct sunlight, so the southern tip is warmer year-round than the higher-latitude north. Higher latitude means cooler, not warmest, so the north being warmest is wrong. Spanning 29 degrees of latitude makes temperatures vary, not equal. Distance from the Himalayas is not a latitude effect, and the south is warmer, not colder.

37. (C) The Tropic is the northern edge of the tropics, so land to its south is tropical and warm year-round while land to its north has sharper seasons. India's south is tropical, so the country is not wholly temperate. Points on the Tropic do get overhead sun near the June solstice, so 'never' is false. The Tropic is a latitude line, not a relief boundary between plains and mountains.

38. (A) Different sunrise times across the country show a wide longitudinal spread, since the Earth turns west to east and brings the east into daylight first. Sunrise timing comes from longitude, not from latitude, which instead governs temperature. India is large, so sunrise is not simultaneous. The Earth turns as one body; the east does not spin faster, longitude explains the gap.

39. (C) A wide latitudinal extent makes the south hotter than the north, and a wide longitudinal extent makes the east see sunrise first, so both facts flow from India's large extent in both directions. A small country would show neither difference. Himalayan uplift comes from plate collision and explains neither the heat gap nor the sunrise gap. A narrow band of latitude and longitude would remove both differences, contradicting the facts.

40. (A) Rising moist air rains heavily on the windward slope and, having lost its moisture, leaves the sheltered side dry, the rain-shadow effect. The dry back side is a consequence of the Ghats, not an unrelated desert. The slope does not freeze the back by blocking sunlight; the cause is moisture loss. Rivers move water after it has fallen, not the rain still in the air, so they do not create the dry zone.

41. (C) In both places humid monsoon air is pushed up over high ground, cools and releases heavy rain, the orographic effect. Neither owes its rain to a neighbouring desert.

Neither is built of coral, and rock type does not attract rain. Both are uplands, not below-sea-level basins; rising, cooling moist air is the shared cause.

42. (A) The shape and height of the land, its relief, decides the scale of farming, with steep cold slopes allowing only terraces and herding while flat warm plains allow large fields. Cooler mountain air does not make farming more intensive; the rugged cold restricts it. Sharing rivers does not make the farming identical when relief and climate differ. Both regions do farm something, so 'neither can' is false.

43. (D) Fertile soil and steady river water let the plains feed dense populations, while the dry Thar's scarce water and poor soil support far fewer people. The Thar is hot, not too cold to inhabit. The plains are not the only flat land; the Deccan and coasts include flat areas. The desert is sunny, not sunless; water and soil are the limits.

44. (A) Each species lives where the region's relief and climate suit it, so India's varied regions produce varied habitats and wildlife. The animals are clearly specialised, so they cannot live anywhere equally well. Wildlife depends strongly on geography, contradicting 'does not depend.' Different regions hold different animals, so they are not all the same.

45. (B) Varied regions from cold mountains to wet deltas to warm reefs offer many habitats, supporting a wide variety of life. India does not have one uniform warm climate; its climates differ greatly. Its rich native wildlife is not all imported. Far from one shared habitat, it has many, which is exactly why biodiversity is high.

46. (B) The barriers slowed contact but left passes and sea routes, so people still came through; they hindered without sealing. They clearly did act as barriers, so denying them is wrong. They restricted people's movement, not just rivers. They are natural features like mountains and seas, not human-made walls.

47. (D) The northern mountains, the western desert and sea, and the encircling oceans together limited easy entry, helping India develop a distinct climate and culture. Random scattered hills form no such frame. The east-coast deltas alone are far too small to shelter a subcontinent. The Lakshadweep reefs are tiny and remote; it is the great outer barriers acting together that matter.

48. (A) Rivers run from the mountains through the plains to the coasts, moving people, trade and ideas across regions and binding them together. They do not give every region the same weather, since climate still varies. They water and link the mainland but do not reach the distant islands. They connect regions as routes; they do not flatten the country into one plain.

49. (D) 'Unity in diversity' names exactly the idea that very different regions and peoples still form one country. 'Survival of the fittest' is about competition in nature, not national unity. 'Divide and rule' is a strategy of splitting people, the opposite of unity. 'Out of sight, out of mind' is about forgetting, unrelated to the chapter's message.

50. (D) Sorting the land by its physical traits lets geographers compare regions and explain why climate, wildlife and life differ from place to place. India's regions plainly differ, so 'all alike' is false. The physical regions follow nature's features, not royal boundaries. Languages do not define these physical regions, which are based on relief, rock and water.

51. (C) Each region shapes its own climate, wildlife and lifestyle while rivers and shared history tie them into one nation, the chapter's full message. Geography clearly shapes life, so 'no effect' is wrong. Every region matters, not only the Himalayas. The land is not the same everywhere, so lives are not identical; diversity within unity is the point.

52. (C) The Himalayas are tall precisely because they are young and still being pushed up, while the ancient Aravallis have eroded low, so great height signals youth, not age, here. The tallest ranges are not the oldest; old ranges erode down. Hardness slows erosion but does not raise a range; uplift does. Snow melts and does not permanently add rock height; the plate collision raises the peaks.

53. (C) Uplift depends on the plate push; remove it and erosion gradually lowers the range, as it has done to ancient ranges. Mountains do not collapse in one event without a cause; the chapter describes gradual change. Tall mountains have no self-lifting force; rising needs the plate push. Rain and snow would still feed rivers, so the range would not suddenly become a desert.

54. (B) The fossils are remains from the old sea floor that was crushed and lifted skyward during the plate collision, recording a former sea raised to height. Glaciers carve and scour rock; they do not source marine fossils. The Arabian Sea is a present ocean to the southwest and never climbed the peaks. Rivers flow downhill, so they cannot carry shells up to summits; uplift of a seabed is the explanation.

55. (B) The belts differ because the ranges stand at different heights, and air cools and thins with altitude, so the high range is cold and the low one warm. The era of uplift does not set today's climate; present altitude does. Rock type does not control regional temperature. All three ranges receive sunlight; the higher ones are cold because of altitude, not darkness.

56. (B) Sailing from the Arabian Sea eastward, the captain meets coral Lakshadweep in the Arabian Sea first, then volcanic Andaman & Nicobar in the Bay of Bengal. Placing the Andamans in the Arabian Sea swaps both group and sea. Saying Lakshadweep is in the Bay of Bengal again misplaces the seas. The two groups lie on opposite sides of the peninsula, so 'both in the Arabian Sea' is false.

57. (D) Several great Himalayan rivers laid and joined their alluvium along one long foredeep trough, building a single continuous plain. Volcanic lava built the Deccan, not the plains, so a lava sheet does not apply. The plain is river alluvium, not a salt layer left by a former sea. Glaciers stay in the high mountains in the chapter and did not sweep the whole lowland flat; merging river silt made it continuous.

58. (D) A small sediment load delivered into a rough open sea is swept away, so the mouth stays a funnel-shaped estuary rather than building land. A delta needs heavy sediment dropped in a calm sea, the opposite of these conditions, so 'larger delta' is wrong. Coral reefs need clear warm shallow seas, not turbulent river mouths. Lagoons form behind bars and spits, not from a river's speed.

59. (A) A channel-split fan of new land is a delta, a body sealed off by a bar is a lagoon, and a funnel where fresh and salt water mingle is an estuary, matching the order given. Putting the estuary first mislabels the land-building fan. Starting with the lagoon misnames the delta. Only one of the three builds a land fan, so calling all three deltas is false.

60. (D) A floor that sinks deeper toward the mountains fits a subsiding trough steadily packed with sediment shed off the rising Himalayas, which is exactly how the plains formed. The bedrock dips down, not up, at the mountain front, so an upward push there contradicts the data. The plains are river alluvium, not a lava sheet, which underlies the Deccan instead. The fill is river-borne mountain debris, not a risen sea floor.